

Dasehri mangoes being packed into crates in a Malihabad orchard

PRASHANTH VISHWANATHAN/GETTY IMAGES

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The patronage of the grand old city's nawabs has created the most famous name in northern India's mango lore: Malihabad. Between Lucknow and Malihabad, near Kakori, lies a village called Dashehri. Here you can still see the 150-year-old parent tree from which come all Dashehri mangoes. The sweet blockbuster rivals the Langra and the Alphonso for popularity. Malihabad and the surrounding regions produce very large Dashehris with flesh so firm it cuts like cake. But if you ask people here, their most favourite mango is the Chausa, which is even sweeter and tastier. But it is not easy to find very good Chausa. The Safeda or Lucknowa is a smaller, spotted mango that is a regional delight.

TRY: Among the numerous mango festivals held here is that at the Kothi Mall near Malihabad. Organised by Sanatkada, it offers food and music and traditional fabrics and mangoes.



TASVEER HASAN

The Kothi Mall in Malihabad

PTI



Rataul mangoes

WESTERN UTTAR PRADESH

Only two new mango varieties have been successful across India—Amrapali and Mallika. Both came out of Saharanpur in this region. You will hear claims here that their Dashehri mango is better than Malihabad's now. This area also produces a lot of Bombay Green, a local favourite. But it is Rataul village in Baghpat that's acquired mango fame to rival Malihabad. The Rataul variety is small, low on fibre and so fragrant it can be smelled from a distance. A variety for the refined palate! The parent tree from which the variety emerged died a few years ago. But the orchards here have scores of varieties.

TRY: Filmmaker and historian Sohail Hashmi conducts annual mango trips to the orchards of Rataul from Delhi. It is an experience. Follow him on social media.